ASE Chromebook App Walkthrough

Speaker script, one section per slide. 18 slides, about 14 minutes at a normal pace.

> Read the text under each slide aloud, or use it as notes. The red line says what to point at on the screen. Every screen in the deck uses made-up sample students, so nothing shown is a real family's information.

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1 Chromebook agreements and check-out, online

30 sec

Point at: the title.

Today I want to show you how we can run the whole Chromebook hand-out without paper. Parents sign the agreements on their phone, the signed forms are saved for us automatically, and on deployment day staff check out each Chromebook in the same app. Everything you will see uses sample students, not real families.

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2 Four stages, from the student list to a Chromebook in hand

45 sec

Point at: the four numbered boxes, left to right.

There are four stages. First, we add our students and their parents. Second, each family gets an email with its own private link. Third, the parent and the student sign three forms in one sitting. Fourth, on deployment day, staff scan the Chromebook and hand it over. All of the data stays inside the school's Google account: a Google Sheet holds the records, a Shared Drive holds the PDFs, and Gmail sends the emails.

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3 The Home page is a to-do list

45 sec

Point at: the five numbered steps on the screenshot.

This is what an administrator sees after signing in with a school Google account. The Home page is a to-do list with five steps. Each step tells us how many are waiting and has a button for it. For example, step two says nine families have not been sent their link, and the button sends it. We can run the whole project from this one page, from top to bottom.

4 Import the list and check it before saving

45 sec

Point at: the words New, Change and Problem in the table.

To add students we upload a spreadsheet file, or simply paste rows from Excel or Google Sheets. Before anything is saved, the app checks every row. Here one student is new, one existing student has a new parent email, and one row has a problem because the grade is missing. Nothing is saved until we press Save. Importing never deletes a student and never sends any email.

5 The Admin sees the email before it goes out

45 sec

Point at: the number of emails at the top, then the preview.

When we press the send button, the app does not send straight away. It shows how many emails will go out, who is left out and why, and the first email exactly as the family will receive it. This family prefers Spanish, so their email is in Spanish. Students with no email on file are listed separately, and we can print a letter with a QR code for them.

6 The parent receives one email with a private link

45 sec

Point at: the blue button and the link below it.

This is the email a parent receives. It names their student and has one button, Sign the agreement. The link ends in a random code that belongs to that one student. It cannot be guessed, and it works once. The parent does not need an account or a password. The email comes from our school account, and replies go to the IT help address.

7 The parent reads the agreement and enters their details

1 min

Point at: the three phones, one at a time.

The form has seven short steps, and it is made for a phone. In step one the parent reads our Chromebook Checkout agreement, with the repair prices and who pays, and ticks a box to agree. In step two they enter their name, phone, email and mailing address. In step three they read the Digital Promise agreement, word for word, with their own name already filled in. They can switch between English and Spanish at any time.

8 Parent and student initial each line, then the Verizon release

45 sec

Point at: the initials next to the ticks on the first phone.

Step four is the Digital Promise checklist. The parent and the student each type their initials once, and then tick both boxes on each of the nine lines. Step five is the Verizon General Release, and the parent ticks one box to agree. If they miss a line, the form tells them which one and does not move on, so we never receive a half-finished form.

9 Both sign with a finger, then download their copies

1 min

Point at: the signature box, then the Download buttons on the last phone.

In step six the parent signs with a finger. That one signature is placed on all three forms, and the screen tells them so. In step seven the student signs and presses Sign and submit. Then they see Thank you, with a Download button for each signed form. After that the link is closed and shows Already signed, so nobody can sign twice.

10 The parent is emailed all three signed forms

30 sec

Point at: the three attachments at the bottom of the email.

Right after signing, the parent also receives a receipt by email with the three PDFs attached. These are the same files we keep, so the family and the school hold identical copies.

11 Three PDFs, each the original form with the blanks filled in

1 min

Point at: each of the three documents.

These are the documents the app saved. On the left is our own Chromebook Checkout form, with the names, the date and both signatures. In the middle is the Digital Promise agreement, with both sets of initials on all nine lines. On the right is the Verizon release. They are the original forms with the blanks filled in. A small line at the bottom of each page records when it was signed, by whom, and for which student.

12 One folder per student, inside a folder per grade

45 sec

Point at: the folder tree, then the orange line.

The app files everything for us in the school's Shared Drive. There is a folder for the school year, a folder for each grade, and inside it one folder for each student. The three signed forms appear there when the family signs. The file shown in orange, the check-out record, is added later on deployment day. Only administrators need access to this Drive folder. Other staff open documents through the app, and each viewing is recorded.

13 The screen says READY or NOT READY

1 min

Point at: the red banner, then the green banner.

Now deployment day. A helper types the student's name and taps the student. If the family has not signed, the screen says NOT READY, shows what is missing, and offers Sign now on this tablet, so the parent can sign on the spot. If all three forms are done, it says READY. Helpers see only the student's name, grade and form status. They never see phone numbers, emails or signatures. A student who is not ready cannot be given a Chromebook.

14 Scan the Chromebook, then check that it works

45 sec

Point at: the asset tag box, then FINISHED.

The helper explains the policy and the repair costs, ticks the box, and scans the asset tag with a barcode scanner. The app checks that the tag exists and is not already with another student. Then the student signs in on the Chromebook, and the helper confirms that it works. The screen shows FINISHED and the helper moves on to the next student.

15 The app writes a check-out record by itself

1 min

Point at: the row "Checked out by" on the document.

The moment a Chromebook is assigned, the app saves a one-page check-out record in the student's folder. It lists the student, the asset tag, the serial number, the date and time, and who checked it out. That name comes from the account the staff member is signed in with, so nobody has to type it and it cannot be skipped. This is why each helper should have their own account. The family's signed agreement is not changed by this.

16 Everything about a student is on one page

45 sec

Point at: the green status line, then the More actions buttons.

For any student we can open one page that shows where they are in plain words. Here it says Has Chromebook, with the asset tag. Under More actions we can open each of the four documents, and do the less common tasks, such as starting a repair, reporting a lost Chromebook, or recording a return. At the bottom is a history of every step, with the date and the person.

17 Reports show who is not ready and what needs attention

45 sec

Point at: the list of students and the Print button.

The reports page lists the students who are not ready and exactly what each one is missing. We can print it or download it to follow up with families. The same page shows progress by grade, our claims rate against the twenty percent VILS limit, late loaners, and Chromebooks that were not returned. There is also a list of every check-out, showing which student got which Chromebook, when, and from whom, and we can save that list as a Google Sheet.

18 Installed for testing. Four things before real families use it

1 min

Point at: the four boxes.

The app is installed in our Google account for testing, and it works there. Four things remain before real families use it. One, a fix to the Checkout PDF, so the old price table is fully removed and not just covered. Two, Digital Promise and Verizon should confirm they accept forms signed this way, and whether Verizon has a release for minors. Three, a few school decisions: the separate check-out record, a review of the Spanish text, and which account the app should run from. Four, we run the full test checklist with sample students, and then import the real list. I am happy to take questions.